



Open PhD Positions

Photon Intelligence Lab @ Stony Brook CS

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My new research group, Photon Intelligence Lab (Φ Lab) at CS department in Stony Brook University, New York is seeking **1-2 PhD students** to begin in **Fall 2026**. If you are interested, please apply through the [CS graduate admissions](#) and mention my name in your statement of purpose. Deadline is **January 15, 2026**. You can also fill out this [Google Form](#) to express your interest.

About Φ lab

We develop computer vision systems that surpass human perception by integrating **computational cameras**, **light transport simulations**, and **physics-aware machine learning**.

These **superhuman vision** systems can, for instance, [look around blind corners](#), [turn objects into computational mirrors](#), and [turn cameras into force sensors](#) – unlocking critical applications in robotics, medicine and science.

Our goal is to enable machines to augment our capabilities and enhance our safety by **seeing the invisible**: around us, inside our bodies and beyond our scientific understanding.



What I am looking for



We are a multi-disciplinary lab working at the intersection of imaging, graphics, AI, and robotics. I am looking for driven and motivated students with background / interest in one or more of these areas:

- **Imaging.** building optical setups, working with unconventional sensors.
- **Graphics.** physics-based rendering algorithms, neural scene representations.
- **AI.** reinforcement learning, diffusion models, transformer-based 3D vision.
- **Robotics.** simultaneous localization and mapping, navigation, manipulation.

Why Stony Brook?

Some perks of being at Stony Brook:

- **Strong focus on computer vision.** We rank in the top 20 universities on csrankings.org for computer vision with faculty expertise in vision-language models, generative AI, bio-medical imaging and robot perception.
- **Great location.** New York City is just a short train ride away. Easy access to beautiful beaches and trails on Long Island.



akshatdave.github.io